GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

From one venue to one thousand.

A phased plan to capture the UK independent hospitality market through content-led growth, strategic partnerships and community-driven expansion.

April 2026 · Confidential

SAFESERV

01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The opportunity

SafeServ combines food safety compliance and workforce management for independent hospitality. 180,000+ UK venues need this — most still use paper.

300	1,500	£100k	£400k
VENUES Y1	VENUES Y2	ARR TARGET Y1	ARR TARGET Y2

Strategy in one line

Start local (Northern Ireland), prove the model, expand to UK cities through content marketing + EHO partnerships + referrals, and scale nationally with product-led growth.

02 — TARGET CUSTOMER

Who we're building for

Independent food businesses with 3–30 staff, £100k–£2M revenue, still using paper or basic free tools.

Primary: The Owner-Manager

Runs 1–2 venues. 5–15 staff. Does the rota themselves. Worries about EHO inspections. Needs something that works out of the box.

Secondary: The Multi-Site Operator

3–8 venues. Wants centralised compliance. Needs consistent processes across sites. Willing to pay more for consistency.

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Cafes

60k+ in UK
Entry: Starter £5

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Pubs

47k+ in UK
Entry: Pro £25

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Restaurants

40k+ in UK
Entry: Pro £25

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Hotels

30k+ in UK
Entry: Pro + Multi

How we talk about SafeServ

Clear, consistent messaging that resonates with time-poor venue owners.

Positioning Statement

For independent hospitality venues who struggle with fragmented compliance and operations tools, SafeServ is the all-in-one platform that replaces paper logs, spreadsheet rotas and WhatsApp coordination with a single, mobile-first app — at a price that makes sense for a 10-person cafe.

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All-in-one

"Stop paying for 5 apps. SafeServ does compliance AND workforce in one platform."

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Built for independents

"Enterprise software doesn't work for a cafe with 6 staff. SafeServ was built for venues like yours."

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Affordable

"From £5/mo. Less than one failed EHO fine. Less than one hour of your manager's time."

KEY PROOF POINTS

- → **Save 5+ hours/week** on rota, timesheets, and compliance admin
- → **Setup in under 10 minutes** — wizard configures features by venue type
- → **No hardware needed** — runs on any phone, tablet or laptop
- → **Staff actually use it** — PIN login, 30 seconds to train
- → **Always inspection-ready** — every check timestamped and audit-ready

04 — ACQUISITION CHANNELS

How we find customers

Prioritise low-cost, high-trust channels first. Scale paid acquisition once unit economics are proven.

CHANNEL	STRATEGY	PRIORITY	CAC
Content / SEO	Blog targeting “HACCP checklist”, “fridge log template”, “pub rota template” — capture search intent, convert to paid.	High	£15–25
EHO Partnerships	Partner with Environmental Health Officers who recommend SafeServ to venues needing to improve their food safety rating.	High	£10–20
Referral Programme	Free month for every venue referred. Hospitality owners know other owners — word of mouth is powerful.	High	£5–15
Social Media	TikTok/Reels: EHO horror stories, before/after paper vs digital, quick food safety tips.	Medium	£10–20
Local Events	Attend hospitality networking events, food festivals. Demo on tablet, sign up on the spot.	Medium	£30–50
Cold Outbound	Target venues with 3-star or lower food hygiene ratings (public data). Personal email or visit.	Medium	£40–60
Google Ads	High-intent keywords from Q3 once organic content provides landing pages.	Later	£50–80
Supplier Partners	Partner with food wholesalers and POS providers. Bundle or referral model.	Later	£20–40

Channel priority logic

High-priority channels combine low CAC with high trust. Blog readers are pre-educated. EHO recommendations carry professional authority. Owner referrals carry social proof.

05 — SALES FUNNEL

From awareness to revenue

Product-led growth with a free trial. The onboarding wizard is the key activation moment.

Awareness — Content, social, EHO referrals, events

Interest — Free trial (14 days, no card)

Activation — Onboarding wizard + first fridge check

Conversion — Paid subscription

Expansion — Upsell, add venues, referrals

40%
TRIAL → ACTIVATED
Complete onboarding wizard

25%
ACTIVATED → PAID
Convert within 30 days

15%
PAID → EXPANDED
Upsell within 6 months

Activation is the key metric

Users who complete onboarding and log their first fridge check within 24 hours convert at 3x the rate. The wizard and “Getting Started” dashboard checklist drive this moment.

06 — PHASED ROLLOUT

Four phases to 1,500 venues

Start local. Prove the model. Expand with content and partnerships.

PHASE 1 — Q2 2026

Local Launch — Northern Ireland

Goal: 20 paying venues. **Channels:** Direct outreach, local events, personal network, 1–2 EHO partnerships. **Budget:** £5k.

PHASE 2 — Q3 2026

Regional Expansion — UK Cities

Goal: 100 paying venues. **Channels:** Content/SEO, referral programme, social media, regional EHO partnerships. **Budget:** £15k.

PHASE 3 — Q4 2026–Q1 2027

National Scale — Full UK

Goal: 300 paying venues. **Channels:** Google Ads, trade shows, supplier partnerships. First CS hire. **Budget:** £30k.

PHASE 4 — H2 2027

Market Leadership — UK + Ireland

Goal: 1,500 paying venues. **Channels:** Partner channel mature, referrals driving 30%+ signups. API integrations, Bluetooth probes. **Budget:** £50k.

07 — CONTENT & PRICING STRATEGY

Own the conversation. Price for adoption.

Content marketing is the primary acquisition engine. Pricing is designed to minimise friction.

CONTENT PILLARS

🩺 Food Safety Compliance
"HACCP checklist template", "How to pass an EHO inspection"

📅 Hospitality Operations
"Free pub rota template", "How to reduce labour costs"

📊 Business Advice
"Calculate food cost %", "Staff retention strategies"

📱 Product Content
Comparisons, walkthroughs, customer stories

MONTHLY CADENCE

Wk 1	Long-form SEO article (2k+ words)
Wk 2	Free downloadable template (lead magnet)
Wk 3	Video/Reel: quick tip or day-in-the-life
Wk 4	Comparison or case study article

PRICING STRATEGY

Land & expand

Starter at £5 is an impulse buy. Get venues on the platform with compliance, then upsell to Pro (£25) when they need rota and time tracking. Multi-venue at £15/extra scales with growth.

EXPANSION TRIGGERS

Starter → Pro
Venue adds 8+ staff or spends 2+ hrs on rota

Single → Multi
Owner opens second location

Monthly → Annual
2 months free after 3 months active use

60%	35%	5%
STARTER Y1	PRO Y1	MULTI Y1

08 — METRICS & RISKS

What we measure. What could go wrong.

GROWTH KPIS

New trials/month	**40–60 by M6**
Trial → Paid	**10%+**
MRR growth	**15–20%/mo**
Referral %	**20%+ of signups**

RETENTION KPIS

Monthly churn	**<5%**
Net Revenue Retention	**110%+**
Daily active staff	**60%+**
Features per venue	**4+ modules**

KEY RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Low staff adoption

Staff resist new tools. Paper feels easier.

Mitigation

PIN login (no email). Permission-aware dashboards. Quick actions faster than paper.

Enterprise moves downmarket

Trail or Navitas launch a "Lite" tier.

Mitigation

Enterprise DNA is hard to shed. Their UX is built for compliance managers, not baristas.

High hospitality churn

Venues close. Budgets get cut.

Mitigation

Starter at £5 resists cuts. Compliance becomes must-have for inspections. Annual billing reduces churn.

The market is ready.
The product is built.

SafeServ is looking for partners and investors who believe independent hospitality deserves better tools.

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